

1. **Preparation:** The social engineer obtains information on their victims, such as where they may be found on social media, by email, or via text message.
2. **Infiltration:** The social engineer approaches their victims, usually imitating a reliable source and validating themselves with the information obtained about the victim.
3. **Exploitation:** Persuasion is used by the social engineer to obtain information from their victim, such as account logins, payment methods, contact information, and so on, that they can use to carry out their cyberattack.
4. **Disengagement:** The social engineer cuts off all communication with their target, launches an attack, and then flees.

These procedures could take anything from a few hours to several months, depending on the type of social engineering approach. Knowing the indicators of a social engineering attack can help you detect — and stop — one quickly, regardless of the time frame.

Types of Social Engineering Attacks

Social engineering attacks come in a variety of shapes and sizes, and they can be carried out at any place there is human interaction. Common types of digital social engineering assaults include the ones listed below.



Baiting



Catfishing



Pretexting



Phishing, Vishing,
Spear Phishing



Scareware



Tailgating,
Piggybacking



Water Holing



Quid Pro Quo

Phishing

Phishing is the act of impersonating a trustworthy entity in order to get sen-